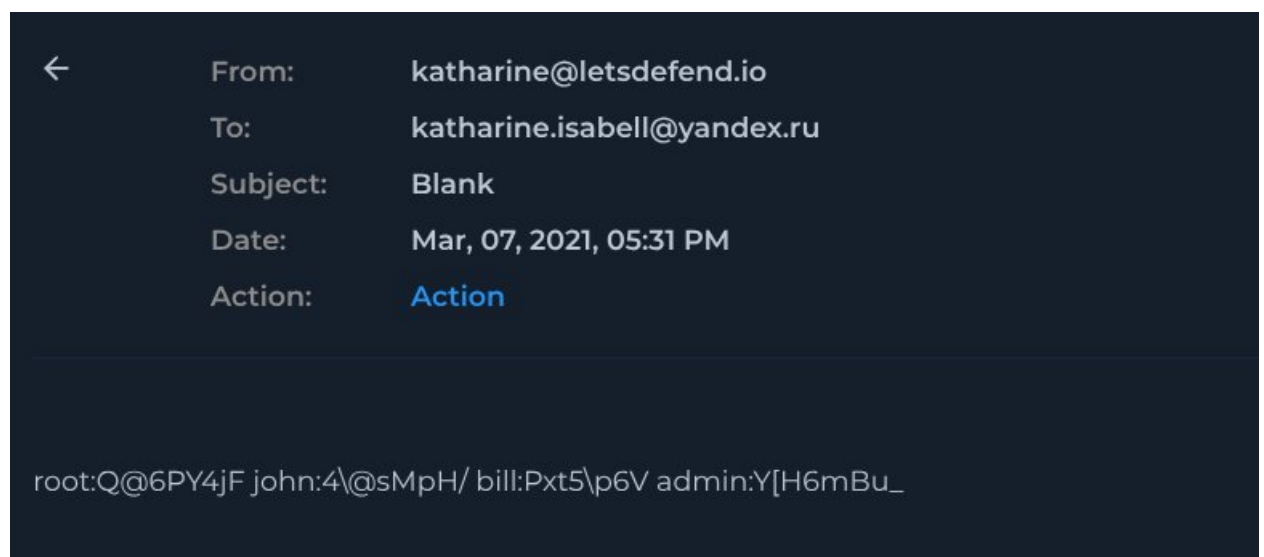


Event Information:

EventID :
74
Event Time :
Mar, 07, 2021, 05:31 PM
Rule :
SOC136 - Data Leak via Mailbox Forwarding Detected
Level :
Security Analyst
SMTP Address :
172.16.20.3
Source Address :
katharine@letsdefend.io
Destination Address :
katharine.isabell@yandex.ru
E-mail Subject :
Blank
Device Action :
Blocked

Analysis Steps:

Logs were searched for the email that triggered the alert.



This email seems to suggest exfiltrations activities via the use of email.

It is strange that the name of both emails are the same and may suggest an insider threat but this must be approached with extreme caution as it may simply be the attacker posing as an employee as a means of misdirection.

Based on following Playbook procedure and the analysis of available information, this alert is determined to be a failed True Positive but it must be ascertained exactly as to how this data exfiltration attempt could be made.

Report:

Incident Summary

Analysis confirms a True Positive, but successfully blocked, data exfiltration attempt. Highly sensitive credential data was detected in an outbound email originating from an internal user account. The email gateway intercepted and blocked the transmission, preventing any data loss. The incident requires immediate escalation to determine if this represents an insider threat or an account compromise.

Incident Details

- **Alert Name:** SOC136 - Data Leak via Mailbox Forwarding Detected
- **Internal Sender:** katharine[[@](#)]letsdefend[.]io
- **External Destination:** katharine.isabell[[@](#)]yandex[.]ru
- **Sender IP:** 172[.]16.20.3
- **Device Action:** Blocked

Analysis and Evidence

- **Exfiltration Payload:** The email body contained cleartext credentials for high-level accounts, specifically identifying passwords for 'root', 'john', 'bill', and 'admin'.
- **Evasion Tactics:** The destination email address shares the internal sender's first name. This is a common tactic used by threat actors to make outbound traffic appear less suspicious or to mimic a user casually forwarding work to a personal device.
- **Impact Verification:** The email action was recorded as "Blocked", confirming the credential list did not leave the corporate network.

Actions Taken

1. Analysed email logs to review the blocked message and its contents.
2. Confirmed the presence of highly sensitive system credentials within the email body.
3. Verified the gateway successfully blocked the outbound transmission, resulting in no data loss.
4. Declared the alert a True Positive.
5. Escalated to initiate a full credential reset for the exposed accounts (root, admin, john, bill) and investigate katharine[[@](#)]letsdefend[.]io for signs of account compromise.

Let's Defend Result

SOC136 - Data Leak via Mailbox Forwarding Detected
True Positive (+5 Point)
Are there attachments or URLs in the email? (+5 Point)